

ENG524 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG 524) CRITICAL DISCOURSE ANALYSIS

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020

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Lecture-01

What is Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA)

Topic-01: Introduction to Discourse Analysis

What is Discourse Analysis?

Discourse Analysis is the examination of language beyond the sentence level, considering linguistic and non-linguistic behavior. It studies language patterns across texts and their social and cultural contexts.

Who introduced the term Discourse Analysis?

Zelling Harris (1952) introduced the term Discourse Analysis.

Why is knowledge about language beyond words, clauses, phrases, and sentences necessary for successful communication?

It is needed to understand the relationship between language and context, as a pragmatic view of language is essential in discourse analysis.

What are the different views or aspects of Discourse Analysis?

Discourse as the social construction of reality, discourse and socially situated identities, discourse and performance, discourse and intertextuality.

What are the four main assumptions of Discourse Analysis?

- a. Language is ambiguous.
- b. Language is always 'in the world.'
- c. The way we use language is inseparable from our social identities.
- d. Language is never used alone; it is combined with other elements like tone, gestures, and text format.

Topic-02: Discourse and Text

How is meaning related to a text, according to Halliday?

Meaning is the most important element of a text, and it must make sense. A text is everything meaningful in a particular situation.

What is genre analysis, and why is it significant in Discourse Analysis?

Genre analysis studies the social functions of different types of texts. It is essential because it helps understand how the structure and features of texts reflect the intentions and identities of the users.

Who was one of the first researchers to examine the discourse structure of texts, and what did he introduce into discourse analysis?

Mitchell (1957) was one of the first to examine discourse structure. He introduced the notion of stages into discourse analysis, representing the steps that language users go through.

What are the three important aspects of genres in discourse analysis?

- a. Genres are communicative events.
- b. Genres have conventions and constraints.
- c. Genres allow for creativity.

Topic-03: The Emergence of CDA

How did Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) develop historically?

CDA developed historically out of Critical Linguistics (CL), emphasizing the role of ideology and power relations in language use.

In what fields is CDS (Critical Discourse Studies) practiced?

CDS is practiced in various fields, including anthropology, business studies, geography, health studies, media studies, psychology, and tourism studies.

What is the primary focus of CDA (Critical Discourse Analysis)?

CDA primarily studies how social power dynamics, abuse, dominance, and inequality are enacted, reproduced, and resisted through text and speech in the social and political context.

Topic-04: Key scholars of CDA

Who is Norman Fairclough, and what is his focus in CDA?

Norman Fairclough is known for his focus on the role of discourse in the production, maintenance, and transformation of the socio-economic order and political struggles.

What is Ruth Wodak's contribution to CDA?

Ruth Wodak developed the Discourse-Historical Approach in CDS, emphasizing the need for multiple theoretical backgrounds in studying complex social issues.

Who is Teun A. van Dijk, and what is his focus in CDA?

Teun A. van Dijk studies the role of power and ideology in discourse, specifically how discourse reproduces sociopolitical beliefs and relations of power.

Topic-05: Approaches of CDA

What are the key approaches in CDA?

- a. Socio-cultural Approach (Fairclough)
- b. Socio-Cognitive Approach (Van Dijk)
- c. Discourse-Historical Approach (Ruth Wodak)

Topic-06: Main tenets of CDA

What are the main tenets of CDA according to Fairclough and Wodak?

CDA addresses social problems, power relations are discursive, discourse constitutes society and culture, discourse does ideological work, discourse is historical, the link between text and society is mediated, discourse analysis is interpretative and explanatory, discourse is a form of social action, critical discourse analysts want to understand, expose, and resist social inequality.

Lecture-02

Cultural Approach to CDA (CCDA)

Topic 01: CCDA as a branch of CDA

What is the main goal of Cultural Approach to Critical Discourse Analysis (CCDA)?

To expose and examine cultural codes embedded in discourse and their contribution to the reproduction of abuses of power.

According to Teun A. van Dijk, what do CDA researchers need to relate political rhetoric to in order to explain it?

Socio-cognitive representations such as attitudes, norms, values, and ideologies.

How does Shi-xu recommend handling discourse saturated with culture?

By using a culturally pluralistic, inclusive, critical, and egalitarian form of academic discourse.

What is the primary goal of Cultural Approach to Critical Discourse Analysis (CCDA)?

The primary goal of CCDA is to expose and examine the ways in which cultural codes are embedded in discourse and how they contribute to the reproduction of abuses of power.

According to Teun A. van Dijk, what should CDA researchers be interested in, and why?

Teun A. van Dijk suggests that CDA researchers should not only describe properties of political rhetoric but also explain them by relating them to

socio-cognitive representations such as attitudes, norms, values, and ideologies.

Topic 02: CCDA: General Principles

What does CCDA focus on within any given 'text'?

The cultural aspects, both verbal and non-verbal.

What is the first principle guiding CCDA's approach?

No text is independent of its cultural contexts.

How does CCDA facilitate the identification of unique cultural elements?

By employing cross-cultural or multi-cultural perspectives.

What does CCDA seek to expose in terms of the rhetoric of power?

The 'global dictionary' of power and manipulation.

What are the key principles that guide CCDA when analyzing texts?

The key principles include considering the cultural context of texts, employing tools from Cultural Studies, using cross-cultural perspectives, and focusing on both verbal and non-verbal practices.

Why does CCDA emphasize the analysis of factual and fictional discourses alike?

CCDA believes that both factual and fictional discourses can act as repositories for cultural codes and contribute to the perpetuation of power abuses.

Topic 03: Cultural Codes and Discursive Strategies

What is CCDA's goal in exposing specific discursive strategies?

To unveil the means (e.g., metaphors, narratives, frames) that promote specific goals (e.g., political agendas or policies).

Topic 04: Critical Narrative Analysis

What is the purpose of Critical Narrative Analysis (CNA) according to Souto-Manning?

To unite CDA and narrative analysis to address theoretical and methodological dilemmas in discourse analysis.

How does narrative contribute to creating a new community and support for a cause, according to Montesano, Montessori, and Morales Lopez?

Narrative helps rearticulate the status quo from an undesired version to a desired version, fostering new identities and mutual relations.

What are the two 'mega' narratives for cultural construction mentioned?

The 'normalizing' narrative and the 'estranging' narrative.

What are some strategies of normalization in the 'War-Normalizing Narrative'?

Euphemization, naturalization, and justification.

What are some strategies of abstraction in the Israeli Peace-Estrangement discourse?

Strategies of distancing and strategies of impersonalization.

How does personifying the state using body metaphors relate to the discourse?

It is a discursive strategy used to discuss the state's actions or characteristics.

Explain the 'Strategies of Normalization' and 'Strategies of Abstraction' in discourse analysis.

'Strategies of Normalization' aim to depict a social object positively, while 'Strategies of Abstraction' involve distancing the object or removing the human factor to focus on organizational structures.

Lecture-03

Introduction of Discourse Historical Approach-1

Topic-01: Introduction

What does "DHA" stand for?

Answer: "DHA" stands for "Discourse-Historical Approach."

What does the label "DHA" emphasize?

The label emphasizes the strong historical research interest of the approach.

What are the key research interests of the DHA?

The key research interests include identity construction and unjustified discrimination, historical dimensions of discourse formation, and identity politics.

Which philosophical influence is associated with the DHA?

The DHA is oriented toward the critical theory of the Frankfurt School and, in particular, toward Habermas's language philosophy.

How many stages does a detailed DHA program ideally follow?

A detailed DHA program ideally follows eight stages.

What does the label "Discourse-Historical Approach" (DHA) stand for, and what does it emphasize?

The label "Discourse-Historical Approach" (DHA) stands for a critical approach to the study of discourse. It emphasizes a strong historical research interest within the approach.

Topic-02: Characteristics and Research Interests of DHA

What is the nature of the DHA approach?

The DHA is problem-oriented and interdisciplinary.

In how many dimensions does the DHA operate?

Answer: The DHA operates in three dimensions: specific contents or topics, discursive strategies, and linguistic means.

What are some areas of discourse studies that DHA is concerned with?

DHA covers areas such as discourse and discrimination, language barriers, discourse and politics, discourse and identity, discourse and history, discourse in the media, organizational communication, and discourse and ecology.

How does the DHA view discourse analysis?

The DHA sees discourse analysis as a multidimensional project that incorporates theory, methods, methodology, and empirically based research practices with concrete social applications.

How does the DHA approach the study of language and what does it emphasize?

The DHA is problem-oriented and interdisciplinary, where the study of language is just one part of the research. It emphasizes analyzing various data sources from different analytical perspectives.

What are the three dimensions of the DHA approach, and what does each dimension involve?

The DHA operates in three dimensions: (1) specific contents or topics of discourse identification, (2) investigation of discursive strategies, and (3) examination of linguistic means as types and specific context-dependent linguistic realizations as tokens.

Topic-03: Discursive Strategies in DHA

What is nomination in the context of DHA?

Nomination involves the discursive construction of social actors, objects, phenomena, events, processes, and actions, particularly how they are linguistically named and referred to in the discourse.

What is predication in DHA?

Predication is the discursive characterization of social actors, objects, phenomena, events, processes, and actions, including the qualities attributed to them, whether positive or negative.

What is argumentation in DHA?

Argumentation involves persuading addressees of the validity of specific claims of truth and normative rightness through the use of arguments.

What is perspectivisation in DHA?

Perspectivisation refers to positioning the speaker's or writer's point of view and expressing involvement or distance in the discourse, specifying the perspective from which nominations, attributions, and arguments are expressed.

What do mitigation and intensification do in DHA?

Mitigation and intensification modify the illocutionary force of utterances in terms of their epistemic or deontic status, indicating whether utterances are overtly articulated, intensified, or mitigated.

What is nomination in DHA, and what does it involve?

Nomination in DHA involves the discursive construction of social actors, objects, phenomena, events, and processes. It concerns how these are linguistically named and referred to in the discourse.

What is predication in DHA, and what does it entail?

Predication in DHA involves the discursive characterization of social actors, objects, phenomena, events, and processes, whether positively or negatively. It relates to the qualities attributed to them in the discourse.

How does DHA approach argumentation, and what is its role in discourse analysis?

DHA views argumentation as a means of persuading addressees of the validity of specific claims of truth and normative rightness. It plays a significant role in discourse analysis by examining the arguments employed in the discourse.

What is perspectivisation in DHA, and what is its purpose?

Perspectivisation in DHA involves positioning the speaker's or writer's point of view and expressing involvement or distance. It pertains to determining the perspective from which nominations, attributions, and arguments are expressed.

How do mitigation and intensification function in discourse according to DHA?

Mitigation and intensification modify the illocutionary force of utterances with respect to their epistemic or deontic status. They influence whether utterances are articulated overtly and whether they are intensified or mitigated.

Lecture-04

Discourse Historical Approach-II

Topic-01: The Concept of Critique

What term was introduced in the 1980s to distinguish from descriptive discourse analysis?

Critical Discourse Analysis

What was the initial focus of Critical Discourse Analysis by Fairclough, van Dijk, and others?

The political meaning of social critique

Name three theoretical sources relevant to understanding critique in Discourse-Historical Approach.

- (a) Critical Theory of the first generation
- (b) The relationship to Foucault
- (c) The later Critical Theory of Jürgen Habermas

What are the four validity claims proposed by Habermas as criteria for a differentiated concept of critique in DHA?

(theoretical) truth, (expressive) truthfulness, normative rightness, comprehensibility

What is the basic claim for every communication in DHA?

The validity claim of comprehensibility

Name the three forms of critique in the DHA.

Text or discourse immanent critique, socio-diagnostic critique, prospective critique

What is the origin and primary focus of "Critical Discourse Analysis" as introduced by Fairclough, van Dijk, and others in the 1980s?

The term "critical discourse analysis" was introduced in the 1980s to distinguish it from descriptive discourse analysis. It primarily focused on the political meaning of social critique, which involves judging the status quo against an alternative state and preferred values. Three theoretical sources informed this concept of critique in the Discourse Historical Approach (DHA): Critical Theory of the first generation, the influence of Foucault's attitude toward critique, and Jurgen Habermas' discourse ethics and theory of deliberative democracy.

Topic-02: The Concept of Discourse

How is discourse characterized in the Discourse-Historical Approach with respect to social reality?

Discourse represents, creates, reproduces, and changes social reality

What are the concrete semiotic units within a discourse?

Tokens or singular signs (sinsigns)

What do actual discursive units relate to in the context of discourse?

Specific genres and other semiotic action patterns (legisigns)

What diversifies the macro-topic into various discourse topics, sub-topics, and content-related argumentation schemes?

The macro-topic of a discourse

What are dispositifs in the context of discourses?

Goal-oriented complexes or networks of discourse, knowledge, power, and subject constitution

What is the role of argumentation in discourse?

Argumentation is a verbal and cognitive pattern of problem-solving, surrounding claims of truth and/or claims of normative rightness.

What are the ten features that characterize the concept of discourse according to the Discourse-Historical Approach?

The ten features that characterize the concept of discourse in the Discourse-Historical Approach are as follows:

- (i) Discourse is a socially constituted and constitutive semiotic practice.
- (ii) Discourse represents, creates, reproduces, and changes social reality.
- (iii) A discourse transcends the unit of a single text or conversation.
- (iv) Discourse is composed of specific groups of actual texts, conversations, and other semiotic events.
- (v) These units relate to specific genres and other semiotic action patterns.
- (vi) Discourses have intertextual links with diverse topics and argumentation schemes.
- (vii) Discourses are situated within fields of action.
- (viii) Discourses contribute to the constitution of social order.
- (ix) Discourses develop around social problems, involving multiple perspectives.
- (x) Discourse undergoes historical change, with strategies like nomination, predication, argumentation, perspectivization, mitigation, and intensification.

How does discourse relate to social reality, according to the Discourse-Historical Approach?

Discourse in the Discourse-Historical Approach both represents and creates social reality. It plays a role in reproducing and changing the social order, making it a socially constitutive and constitutive semiotic practice.

Topic-03: The Concept of Context

What dimensions of context are distinguished in the Discourse-Historical Approach?

Immediate co-text and co-discourse, intertextual and interdiscursive relationships, social factors and institutional frames, broader sociopolitical and historical context

What is the fourth dimension of context that the DHA pays special attention to?

The historical context

How does the DHA perform discourse-historical analysis related to a single utterance?

By reconstructing the prehistory of the utterance by relating the present to the past

What does the DHA consider in a diachronic series or sequence of discourse fragments or utterances?

The historical interrelationships within a specific period

What is recontextualization in the context of discourse-historical analysis?

The analysis of the historical dimension of discourses by examining how different actors talk, write, or represent the past

Why is the historical context significant in the DHA?

Because discourses undergo historical change relating to social change, and historical analysis is crucial.

What are the four dimensions of "context" distinguished by the Discourse-Historical Approach?

The Discourse-Historical Approach distinguishes among four dimensions of "context":

- (i) Immediate, language-internal co-text and co-discourse.
 - (ii) Intertextual and interdiscursive relationships between utterances, texts, genres, and discourses.
 - (iii) Social factors and institutional frames in a specific context of situation.
 - (iv) Broader sociopolitical and historical context integrated into the analysis.
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Lecture-05

Fairclough's Model of CDA

Topic-01: Introduction to Fairclough's Model of CDA

What does Fairclough's definition of Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) emphasize?

Causality and determination in discursive practices, events, and texts, and their ideological shaping by power and struggle over power.

How does CDA differ from lay critique, according to Fairclough?

CDA uses systematic approaches to inherent meanings, relies on scientific procedures, and incorporates self-reflection of researchers.

What aspect of discourse practice dimension is neglected by some approaches to CDA, according to Fairclough?

The intertextuality and discourse practice dimension.

What does Fairclough adapt from Foucault's work when discussing discursive practices associated with social domains?

The concept of the order of discourse.

Why should the categories of power, social class, and ideology be considered in Discourse Analysis, according to Fairclough?

They are essential in understanding how discursive practices, events, and texts are shaped and function.

How does Fairclough suggest investigating the distribution of texts within orders of discourse?

By examining 'chain' relationships within discourse orders.

How does Fairclough define Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA), and what is its primary goal?

Fairclough defines CDA as a form of discourse analysis that aims to explore the relationships of causality and determination between discursive practices, events, and texts. Its primary objective is to uncover how these discursive elements are ideologically shaped by the dynamics of power and the struggle over power.

What concept did Fairclough adapt from Foucault when discussing discursive practices associated with specific social domains?

Fairclough adapted the concept of the "order of discourse" from Foucault, which refers to the ordered set of discursive practices associated with a particular social domain or institution, such as the lecture, seminar, counseling, or informal conversation in an academic institution.

Topic-02: Aspects of Fairclough's Model 3D Approach

What are the three stages of Fairclough's 3D model of CDA?

Description, interpretation, and explanation.

In the description stage, what linguistic features are systematically analyzed?

Choices in vocabulary, grammar, and text structure.

What is the focus of the interpretation stage in Fairclough's model?

Hypothesizing the cognition of readers/listeners and examining the relationship between discourse, its production, and consumption.

How does Fairclough's explanation stage in CDA connect texts to the wider social and cultural context?

It critically explains the connections between texts and the sociocultural practice, particularly in terms of ideology.

According to Fairclough, why is a suitable theory of language important for discourse analysis?

Language is constitutive of social identities, social relations, and systems of knowledge and belief, and it can be both socially reproductive and socially transformative.

What does Fairclough mean by the "technologization of discourse" in the context of sociocultural change?

It refers to top-down interventions to change discursive practices within orders of discourse, connecting macro and micro analyses of discursive events.

How does intertextual analysis relate to linguistic analysis in Fairclough's approach?

It mediates the connection between language and social context, helping bridge the gap between texts and contexts in discourse analysis.

What is the focus of the interpretation stage in Fairclough's 3D model, and what does it aim to understand?

The interpretation stage is focused on understanding how readers/listeners might interact with the text, including their cognitive processes. It seeks to interpret the

relationships between discourse, its production, and its consumption, while also considering speech acts and intertextuality, which link the text to its context.

How does Fairclough view 'language' and 'order of discourse' in the context of a discursive event?

Fairclough considers 'language' and 'order of discourse' as two centripetal forces in any discursive event. 'Language' is seen as a form of social practice that can be both conventional and socially reproductive or creative and socially transformative, depending on the social circumstances.

Working on the Next Lessons

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